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MONTHLY MARKET SNAPSHOT · NOVEMBER 2026

Central Texas: Rates, Inventory & Winning Tight Offers

Hi [Partner Name],

Here's your November market snapshot for Central Texas.

Rates and market context

This note does not include a verified Texas rate sheet. The dated national readings below are the sources, and I confirm each buyer's numbers in real time rather than relying on an earlier quote.

Mortgage News Daily reported on Nov 6 that the average lender's rates held at their lowest level since Sept 22 despite a much stronger-than-expected jobs report. Freddie Mac's weekly survey (Nov 5) showed a third straight weekly decline. Separately, MBS Highway's National Housing Index, a sentiment-based gauge of buyer activity and price direction, fell to 15 in October, its fifth straight monthly decline. It measures sentiment, not the number of buyers. These are recent readings, not forecasts.

Inventory: what the numbers show

Our benchmark is the Austin-Round Rock-San Marcos metro. Unlock MLS's latest report covers September 2026 and was published Oct 13:

- 13,465 active listings, down 3.4% from September 2025; 5.4 months of inventory

- 3,546 new listings, up 2.8%
- 2,223 closed sales, down 14.8%; 2,313 pending sales, down 1.8%
- Median sales price of $421,000, up 1.4%
- Homes closed at an average 92.7% of list price, compared with 91.4% a year earlier

Bell County note: Killeen had 1,383 active listings in September, up 2.6% year over year, with a median of 66 days on market, according to Realtor.com data reported by the Killeen Daily Herald. Different source and method, so don't compare it directly. Austin figures do not describe Temple or Belton.

What it means for your buyers and sellers

Austin metro supply sits in the range many analysts consider balanced. Closed sales fell faster than pending sales, and the close-to-list ratio improved from last year, but buyers still have room to negotiate on price and terms. Sellers should price from recent neighborhood comparables, not metro headlines.

Price cut or seller concession?

With the same financing assumptions, a lower price can reduce the loan amount and principal-and-interest payment. A seller concession is not cash handed to the buyer. Subject to program limits, it can be applied toward closing costs or a rate buydown, which may lower the payment. Which helps more depends on whether the buyer is short on cash or stretched on payment. Concession limits vary by loan program and down payment. I can run side-by-side scenarios first.

Look past the interest rate

Texas property tax rates vary by city, county, school district and special districts such as MUDs, and many newer Central Texas neighborhoods carry HOA dues. Homeowners insurance premiums also vary by home age, roof and location. Ask for the seller's tax bill, HOA dues and any special assessments early, and get an insurance quote during the option period.

Winning tight offers together

- **Fully underwritten approval, when it fits:** income, assets and credit reviewed by underwriting up front. Remaining conditions, such as appraisal, title, insurance and the final contract review, still apply, and approval is never a guarantee to close.
- **Listing-agent call:** I'll call the listing agent to learn what the seller values most: certainty, a closing date, a rent-back or fewer repair asks.
- **Timelines I can verify:** I'll confirm a realistic closing date before the offer goes in.

- **Protections stay in:** we compete on preparation and responsiveness, never by waiving inspection, appraisal or financing protections.
- **Keep qualification steady:** remind buyers to avoid new credit, big purchases, job changes or unexplained deposits until closing.

Have a buyer to talk through, or want scenarios for a listing? **Call James at (512) 228-8124**, or have your buyer start an application.

Thanks for the partnership,
James



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Sources (latest available as of Nov 7, 2026):

- Unlock MLS September 2026 Central Texas Housing Report (Oct 13 2026)
- Killeen Daily Herald, Killeen September 2026 Realtor.com data
- Mortgage News Daily, Nov 6 2026
- Freddie Mac PMMS, Nov 5 2026
- MBS Highway Housing Index, Oct 13 2026

Market figures are recent published readings, not forecasts. They are published averages and local reports, not personal rate quotes or offers to lend. Rates, programs and approval are subject to qualification, underwriting, property eligibility and market changes; no rate, approval or closing date is guaranteed. NMLS# 215987.